

MIZUMI 泓



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OTSUMAMI
Sashimi Steamed Egg Custard with Yuba Skin ゆば玉締め蒸し
Ibaraki Broad Bean with Bean Curd Purée 茨城県産蚕豆の白和え
Deep-Fried Yamagata Glass Shrimp 山形県産白海老唐揚げ
Simmered Hokkaido Babylon Shell with Sweet Soy Sauce 北海道産白ばい貝旨煮
Kyoto Mibuna and Iwate Shiitake Mushroom Marinated in Soy Sauce and Dashi Broth 壬生菜と焼椎茸の煮浸し
Seasonal Sashimi of Kanpachi, Chūtoro, Hirame with Uni 旬の刺し身：間八、中トロ、平目と雲丹
Hotate Sashimi 帆立刺し身
Fried Hotaruika, Raw Hotaruika, and Ankimo フライ蛍烏賊、蛍烏賊の刺し身、あん肝
Trio of Marugo with Negitoro, Caviar and Shiso Flower まるご三種目とネギトロ、キャビア、と紫蘇の花
Kegani Temaki with Shiso Tempura and Uni 毛蟹手巻きと紫蘇天麩羅と雲丹
Nodoguro Yakimono, with Tofu 喉黒焼きと豆腐

SUSHI
Shima Aji 縞鯨
Akagai 赤貝
Aburi Hokkigai 炙り北寄貝
Botan Ebi and Uni 牡丹海老と雲丹
Kuruma Ebi 車海老
Aburi Kinmedai 炙り金目鯛
Otoro 大トロ
Otoro and Aburi Kamatoro 大トロと炙りカマトロ
Aji 鯨
Hirame no Angawa 平目のアン側
Negitoro ネギトロ
Anago 穴子



CODA
Uni Gunkan-Maki 雲丹軍艦巻き
Ikura Unidon イクラ雲丹丼
Minced Otoro Hosonaki-Maki 大トロ細巻き
Miso Soup 味噌出し
Shizuoka Melon 静岡メロン
Lemon Sorbet レモンシャーベット
Mignardise ミニマルデイズ



The maitre d' of Mizumi, Mr. Handa, arranged a twist of the deluxe sushi set menu and the iconic chef omakase menu to let us fully explore as many possibilities as possible. The first courses served are the two appetizers from the two menus. From the deluxe sushi set, we tried the Kyoto mibuna and Iwate shiitake mushroom marinated in soy sauce and dashi broth; As for the one from the omakase menu, we explored a combination of sashimi steamed egg custard with Yuba skin, Ibaraki broad bean with bean curd purée, deep-fried Yamagata glass shrimp, and simmered Hokkaido Babylon shell with sweet soy sauce. The two otsumami courses are ordinary in terms of flavor, and some of the ingredients are not working very well with each other that resulted in a somehow harsh sensation on the palate. The mibuna is completely overshadowed by the rich umami of shiitake, and the egg custard (chawanmushi) is too rich that doesn't deliver the essential lightness. As for the deep-fried shrimp, I don't think it deserved such a front position as the deep-frying process invokes too much greasiness yet dryness on the mouth. After the first two otsumami, we are finally served with some refreshing bites that consist of seasonal sashimi. The sashimi is served with shiso leaves, myōga (aka Japanese ginger), and julienned daikon. However, there are no specific instructions on which to pair with which. Nevertheless, the Kanpachi tastes fantastic. It is much firmer and has a clear white fish texture that is chewy yet sophisticated at the same time. As for chūtoro, however, it reveals a much richer unctuousness, and the texture is softer.

After a climax of chūtoro, we ran into something still rich yet in an altered way. Here the perfect combination of hirame sashimi and uni emerged, served with menegi (Pousse d'Oignon Vert). To enhance the flavor, the chef offered two ways. One is dipping the uni-hirame roll in uni soy sauce, and the other is with pink sea salt. By applying sea salt, the umami of hirame is amplified without adding additional flavors. The uni soy sauce, on the other hand, does add another dimension of darker flavor to the combo, which for me is rich but overshadowing the flesh's umami per se. I prefer enjoying the hirame uni combo with just a dash of sea salt, which not only amplifies the umami of hirame as I mentioned earlier but also gives enough space for the uni to shine through. Next, we are served with Hotaruika prepared in two ways as well as two small chunks of ankimo. The fried hotaruika, just like the first deep-fried shrimp, has an over-fried thick batter layer that seriously destroys the texture of hotaruika inside. The raw ones are also over-flavored. I can only sense soy sauce and scallion but not the fresh hotaruika taste itself. The ankimo is mediocre, definitely not among the good ones I tasted. It does not carry an even texture, which affects its level of smoothness on the palate.





After the trios, we are served with a kegani temaki. The kegani is freshly steamed and is still very hot when being presented to us.

In the temaki, there are shiso leaf tempura and uni, which not only added multiple dimensions of textures but flavors as well. For the last otsumami, we are presented with a yakimono of the prestige fish nodoguro, which is famous for its rich unctuousness and alluring aroma when being grilled. In this dish, the nodoguro is paired with tofu and myōga, as well as mibuna. From my perspective, the tofu and the mibuna vegetable are unnecessary. None of them works well with the nodoguro. Moreover, the soy sauce is way too briny and pungent.





Then we move on to the sushi section, or more precisely, the nigiri section. We order both the deluxe sushi set and the omakase, and thus we both get to try every sushi from the two menus. If there are shared items in both menus, we both get one piece of nigiri; If the nigiri is only in one of the menus, the chef will cut it half so both of us can try the nigiri. The sushi rice (shari) at Mizumi is flavored with dark vinegar, yet the level of acidity remains low. In addition, the rice is too sticky due to overcooking. Its flavor is also overshadowed by dark vinegar. For the seafood on top, I believe the shells and shrimps are much better than the fish. Most of the fishes are indeed rich in unctuousness, but too much unctuousness will inevitably result in fewer flavors of the ingredients per se. In that way, our mouth will not only be too greasy after several pieces of sushi but will also fail to detect the different flavors of each fish. Notably, many pieces of nigiri are either cooked (like the kuruma ebi and the anago, which is normal) or torched (aka aburi), which invokes the heaviness throughout the sushi section. Not to mention that many are even accented by scallions.



Three pieces of nigiri are consist of maguro, but none of them uses akami. The first one is already an ōtoro, followed by negitoro, which is minced meat from the side of the ōtoro part. The final one is even greasier as a piece of grilled kamatoro is added. While our palate is coated by rich unctuousness, a uni gunkan-maki and uni-ikura don are served to rescue our palate. The uni used is creamy yet refreshing, which lingers on the mouth with sweetness and flavors of tropical fruit reminiscent of mango.



After the last piece of nigiri (anago), we are served with miso soup and desserts. Later on, we are invited to take a photo with the master sushi chef Fujikawa Hideki. Overall, I would tag the Mizumi Macau restaurant as a contemporary chain restaurant. The cuisine here is not very traditional, and the vibes here are indeed very casino-ish. Japanese cuisine is quite interesting. For those daily restaurants like a ramen place or an Izakaya that would serve katsudon, the flavors there are usually piquant and pungent. For those high-end places like a traditional sushi omakase place or a kaiseki restaurant, the essence is to keep the flavor light and pristine so that the natural flavors can be magnified. I was expecting Mizumi to be the rear one, but unfortunately, the style and the extravagant use of scallion and soy sauce remind me of an Izakaya restaurant.